



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tennessee Christian Preparatory School

School Website: <https://www.tennesseechristian.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Tennessee Christian Preparatory School (TCPS)**

Website audited: <https://www.tennesseechristian.org/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Why: Strong, explicit Christian religious foundations and regular liturgical life (daily Bible, weekly chapel, worship; integration of “Biblical truth” across subjects) align well with classical metaphysical and theological grounding. Middle School curriculum requires Latin and Logic; Upper School explicitly uses Harkness discussions (Socratic-style). However, the school’s stated purpose and public framing are dominated by “college preparatory” language, there is no public articulation of “truth, goodness, and beauty” (beyond a chapel letter touching “truth”), no visible Great Books list or trivium/quadrivium structure, and little evidence of lower-school chanting/memorization pedagogy, published rhetoric/thesis work, teacher-formation language, or parent formation. - Most important insights: - Religious/metaphysical: Chapel and worship are central; mission and leadership letters emphasize integrating Biblical truth across the curriculum; Upper School includes apologetic theology, and chapel culture is formative (positive). - Curriculum/pedagogy: Latin and Logic in Middle School; Harkness (discussion) in Upper School (positive), but no public great books/trivium/rhetoric thesis promises and limited evidence of chanting/recitation or scholé (gaps). - Purpose/goal: Repeated “college preparatory,” “college credit” signals weigh against a classical aim framed around virtue/wisdom/beauty; only scattered “truth” language appears in a chapel letter, not as a curricular aim (mixed).

Method note: The keyword criteria and scoring follow the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” indicators and lexicon (positive/negative signals such as truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, chapel, Socratic/Harkness, scholé, wonder, chanting vs. project-based, career readiness).

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - “Christ-Centered,” “Biblical worldview,” “daily bible classes,” “Chapel,” “worship,” “praise to our Heavenly Father,” “integrating Biblical truth into every subject,” “apologetic theology,” “truth found in Christ”. - Match to Positive Indicators: - Theology / Sacred Scripture: “daily bible classes,” “apologetic theology,” “Biblical worldview,” “integrating Biblical truth” (theology, sacred scripture, Christian worldview). - Liturgical/communal: “Chapel,” “worship,” “praise band leading chapel,” leadership reflections on Wednesday chapel (liturgy, communal worship). - Transcendentals: “truth” mentioned in chapel letter (partial alignment to “truth, goodness, beauty”). - Negative indicators not found: - No “values-neutral,” “religiously neutral,” “comparative religion as non-committal,” etc. (none observed). - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +8 (theology, scripture, chapel, worship, Biblical worldview, apologetics, integrating faith, “truth”) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00; Coverage: 0.80 (we do not see an explicit, sitewide framing around “goodness and beauty” or a formal “liturgy” vocabulary across divisions) - Category rating: CLASSICAL

Citations: Division pages (Lower/Middle/Upper), Talon chapel letters, and “religious foundations” lexicon and indicators.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - “quality college preparatory education,” “earning college credit,” “Academic Excellence,” “educating the mind and the soul,” “Christ-Centeredness,” “integrating Biblical truth into every subject,” chapel letter emphasizing “truth found in Christ”. - Positive indicators vs. negative: - Positive: “educating the mind and the soul” (formation), “truth (in Christ)” (pursuit of truth), Biblical worldview aim (formation). - Negative: repeated “col-

lege preparatory,” “college credit” (college-and-career framing rather than virtue/wisdom as telos). - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +3 (formation language, truth, faith-integrated aim) - Negative hits: -3 (college preparatory emphasis and college credit as primary framing) - Percent positive: 0.50; Coverage: 0.50 (few explicit mentions of “virtue,” “wisdom,” or “goodness/beauty” as ends) - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Citations: Mission and About pages, Upper School, chapel letter, and goals keywords list.

Element 3: Curriculum Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - Middle School includes “Latin and Logic” plus “history” (not “social studies”) alongside math, science, English; Upper School mentions “apologetic theology” and “foreign language”. - Match to Positive Indicators: - Trivium cues: Logic (explicit); Latin (classical language); history (named as history, not social studies). - Missing/weak signals: - No public “Great Books,” “Great Conversation,” published trivium/quadrivium framing, explicit rhetoric sequence, or senior thesis listed. - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +4 (Latin, Logic, History-as-History, Theology/Apologetics) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00; Coverage: 0.50 (several major classical markers unmentioned publicly) - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Citations: Division pages and curriculum indicators/lexicon.

Element 4: Pedagogy (Teaching Methods) Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - “Harkness discussions” in Upper School (Socratic/dialectic pedagogy). - Also mentions “hands-on projects and experiments” (experiential; may trend non-classical if dominant). - Match to Positive/Negative Indicators: - Positive: Harkness = Socratic seminar/dialectic (explicit). - Negative: “hands-on projects and experiments” aligns with experiential/project-based signals when emphasized (one reference; not dominant). - No explicit lower-school “chanting/singing for memory,” “recitation,” or scholé/restfulness language (fine arts/music and chapel singing are present but not articulated as memory pedagogy). - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +1 (Harkness/Socratic) - Negative hits: -1 (experiential/hands-on note) - Percent positive: 0.50; Coverage: 0.40 - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Citations: Upper School page and pedagogy lexicon/indicators.

Element 5: Faculty Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - “faculty ... committed to helping each student thrive” (generic); no visible “teachers as mentors,” “faculty of friends,” “portrait of a teacher,” or classical formation language for teachers on public pages. - Match to Positive/Negative Indicators: - Lacks classical faculty language (mentors, sages, living curriculum, classical teacher formation). - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +0 - Negative hits: -0 (no contradictory signals, just thin evidence) - Percent positive: 0.00; Coverage: 0.10 - Category rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Citations: Upper School text; faculty indicators lexicon.

Element 6: Parents & Community Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on site: - “We cherish the opportunity to partner with your family” (Head of School letter) and Family Teacher Organization (FTO) community events—both indicate community and some partnership with parents. - “Community Oriented” language in Lower and Middle School pages; mentorship circles and schoolwide gatherings show communal ethos (though not explicit parent formation). - Match to Positive/Negative Indicators: - Positive: partnership with parents/community events (partial alignment). - Missing: Parent education/book groups on classical education; explicit parent-as-co-educator language/policies. - Tally and estimate: - Positive hits: +3 (partner language; FTO; community emphasis) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00; Coverage: 0.40 - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Citations: Talon letters and division pages plus parent/community lexicon.

Aggregate Assessment - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (1.00 pos; 0.80 coverage; +8/-0) - Purpose and Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (0.50 pos; 0.50 coverage; +3/-3) - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (1.00 pos; 0.50 coverage; +4/-0) - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (0.50 pos; 0.40 coverage; +1/-1) - Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (0.00 pos; 0.10 coverage; +0/-0) - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (1.00 pos; 0.40 coverage; +3/-0)

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (actionable next steps for TCPS) - Purpose and goal: Publicly reframe your telos in classical terms—virtue and wisdom as ends; explicitly name “truth, goodness, and beauty” (and, if appropriate, “wonder” and “human flourishing”) as guiding lights across divisions, not just in chapel letters. - Curriculum: - Publish a Great Books/primary texts spine per grade bands and explicitly reference “joining the Great Conversation” and the seven liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium). - Show Upper School rhetoric sequence (formal Rhetoric, orations, senior thesis/defense) and the continuity from Logic to Rhetoric. - Pedagogy: - State Socratic/seminar methods across Upper School (Harkness already present; broaden to “Socratic seminar”) and add evidence of chanting/recitation/memory work in the Lower School and Logic School (songs, chants, catechisms, poetry recitation) and a posture of scholé/restful learning where appropriate. - Faculty: - Publish a “portrait of a teacher” and “portrait of a graduate,” and highlight teachers as mentors/living curriculum; note teacher formation in classical pedagogy and faculty colloquia on Great Books. - Parents & Community: - Add parent formation offerings (book studies on classical education, evening talks, “classical 101” seminars) and articulate a parent partnership/covenant that names parents as primary educators in harmony with the school.

Evidence excerpts (from the site) - Mission: “provides a quality college preparatory education, from a Biblical worldview, ... educating the mind and the soul” (homepage and About). - Lower School: “weekly chapel,” “Christ-Centered,” “biblical worldview”. - Middle School: “daily bible classes ... Chapel,” “Latin and Logic” with math, science, history, English. - Upper School: “Harkness discussions ... apologetic theology ... foreign language ... earning college credit”. - Chapel culture: weekly Wednesday chapel worship, partnering with families, integrating Biblical truth into every subject (Talon letters).

Note on criteria - Keyword framework and indicators follow “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” and the classicality lexicon (e.g., “truth, goodness, beauty,” “Socratic,” “scholé,” “chanting,” and negative signals like “college and career readiness,” “project-based” as primary).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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